

Jiayu Kamessi Zhao

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- APPOINTMENT** **Assistant Professor** July 2026 - Present
Operations, Information, and Technology Area, Graduate School of Business
Stanford University, Palo Alto, CA
- EDUCATION** **Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)**, Cambridge, MA 2020 - 2025
Ph.D. in Operations Research
GPA: 5.0/5.0 Advisor: Daniel Freund
- Columbia University**, New York, NY 2016 - 2020
B.S. in Operations Research
Summa Cum Laude
- PUBLICATIONS AND PREPRINTS** *“The Value of a Little Flexibility in Stable Matching,”* with Daniel Freund and Sébastien Martin. Available at SSRN 6208698, 2026.
 • **27th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC’26)**
- “Two-sided Flexibility in Platforms,”* with Daniel Freund and Sébastien Martin.
Major Revision at **Operations Research**, 2026. Available at Arxiv 2404.04709.
 • **MIT ORC Best Student Paper Award**, 2024
- “On the Power of Delayed Flexibility: Balls, Bins, and a Few Opaque Promotions,”*
with Daniel Freund and Chamsi Hssaine.
Major Revision at **Operations Research**, 2026. Available at Arxiv 2306.01968.
- “On the Supply of Autonomous Vehicles in Platforms,”* with Daniel Freund and Ilan Lobel. 2025. **Manufacturing & Service Operations Management** 28(2):496-516.
 • **25th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC’24)**
 • Accepted for presentation at **2024 MSOM Supply Chain Management SIG**
- “Overbooking with Bounded Loss,”* with Daniel Freund. 2022.
Mathematics of Operations Research 48(3): 1344-1363.
 • **22nd ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC’21)**
- WORK IN PROGRESS** *“Stay, Reposition, or Recharge: Battery-Aware Operation of Robotaxi Fleets,”* with Saif Benjaafar and Philipp Afèche.
- “Robotaxis as Capacity Expansion: Certification-Based Pricing and Matching,”* with Huiwen Jia, Xuchen Liu and Siqian Shen.
- EXPERIENCES** **Waymo**, Mountain View, CA 2025 - 2026
Postdoctoral Researcher at the Marketplace and Supply Optimization Team
 • Designed Waymo’s first optimization program for vehicle positioning; developed a batch-optimization framework for real-time control of the autonomous fleet.
- Uber Technologies, Inc.**, San Francisco, CA Summer 2023 & 2024
Applied Scientist Intern at Uber Eats Eater Realtime Pricing (ERTP) Team
 • Improved the convex optimization program for Uber Eats’ real-time pricing and incentive design; enhanced the real-time acceptance rate model and the chained supply model for mitigating surge demand

MIT ORC, Cambridge, MA 2020 - 2025
Research Assistant Supervisor: Daniel Freund

Simons Institute for the Theory of Computing, UC Berkeley, CA Fall 2022
Participant of the Data-Driven Decision Processes Program

Columbia IEOR Department, New York, NY 2018 - 2020
Research Assistant Supervisors: Jay Sethuraman, Soulaymane Kachani.

TEACHING

MIT, Cambridge, MA
TA for *15.761 Operations Management* (MBA) Spring 2022, 2023, 2024
TA for *15.S25 Experience in Operations Research* (PhD) Summer 2022

Columbia University, New York, NY
TA for *Math 2030 Ordinary Differential Equations* (Undergrad) Fall 2018
TA for *IEOR E3658 Probability for Engineers* (Undergrad) Fall 2018

SELECTED TALKS

“Stay, Reposition, or Recharge: Battery-Aware Operation of Robotaxi Fleets”
- MSOM Conference, Jul 2026, Cambridge

“The Value of a Little Flexibility in Stable Matching”
- INFORMS APS Conference, Jul 2025, Atlanta

“On the Power of Delayed Flexibility: Balls, Bins, and a Few Opaque Promotions”
- Marketplace Innovation Workshop, May 2025, Virtual

“Two-sided Flexibility in Platforms”
- UC Berkeley eMERGE Seminar Series, Mar 2026, Berkeley
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Oct 2025, Atlanta
- INFORMS APS Conference, Jul 2025, Atlanta
- University of British Columbia, Imperial College, London Business School, University College London, National University of Singapore, New York University, University of Toronto, Duke University, Stanford University, Columbia University
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Oct 2024, Seattle
- Inaugural OM Rookiepalooza at Kellogg, Oct 2024, Evanston
- MIT ORC Fall Seminar Series, Nov 2024, Cambridge
- RMP Conference, Jul 2024, Los Angeles
- MSOM Conference, Jul 2024, Minneapolis
- Marketplace Innovation Workshop, May 2024, Virtual
- MIT LIDS Student Conference, Feb 2024, Cambridge
- Xi'an Jiaotong University, Jan 2024, Xi'an, China
- Shanghai University of Finance and Economics, Dec 2023, Shanghai, China

“On the Supply of Autonomous Vehicles in Platforms”
- Guest lecture for *INDENG 150: Production Systems* and *INDENG 250: Production and Logistics Models*, Nov 2025, Berkeley
- MIT Operations Management Seminar, Oct 2024, Cambridge

- MSOM Conference Supply Chain Management SIG, Jun 2024, Minneapolis
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Oct 2023, Phoenix
- Cornell Young Researchers Workshop, Oct 2023, Ithaca
- MSOM Conference, Jun 2023, Montreal, Canada
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Oct 2022, Indianapolis
- Marketplace Innovation Workshop, May 2023, Virtual

“Overbooking with Bounded Loss”

- EC’21, Jul 2021, Virtual
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Oct 2021, Virtual
- ORC Student Seminar, Apr 2022, Cambridge

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES	Reviewer for <i>Management Science, Operations Research, Manufacturing & Service Operations Management</i>	2025 - Present
	Reviewer for the ACM STOC Conference	2026
	Reviewer for the ACM EC Conference	2025-2026
	Reviewer for the MSOM Conference	2025
	MIT ORC Seminar Series student coordinator	Fall 2023
	MIT Operations Management Seminar student co-organizer	2021 - 2023

HONORS AND AWARDS	Dan & Eva Roos Thesis Award	2025
	MIT ORC Best Student Paper Award	2024
	The Sebastian B. Littauer Award, Columbia University	2020
	Tau Beta Pi Honor Society, Columbia University (NY Chapter)	2018 - 2020
	The Dean’s List, Columbia University,	2016 - 2020
	C.P. Davis Scholar, Columbia University	2016